

Chapter 64-2

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When Liang Shi returned to the car, Ling Dang was sitting in the back left seat watching her iPad, while Rainbow held a novel in her hands.

She glanced at the cover—it was a very famous science fiction novel in this world.

Online reviews of this book were mixed: those who understood it praised it to the skies, while those who didn't were completely bewildered.

Some people even used education level to categorize readers, claiming that 90% of those who could understand this book had at least a bachelor's degree.

Although this hadn't been verified through big data, most people agreed with this assessment.

It seemed Rainbow was a science fiction fan.

Even though she had been with Rainbow for quite some time, Liang Shi still couldn't quite adapt to this genius girl's persona.

At five years old, she was reading science fiction novels that many adults found obscure, and she was completely absorbed in them, while her peers were still reading "Bunny Don't Cry."¹

However, Liang Shi had come to accept this reality.

There were simply people in this world whose starting point was farther than others' endpoints.

Besides, children who read science fiction novels weren't necessarily unhappy.

Liang Shi turned around to ask the two children, "Do you want to eat something or play?"

Rainbow was the first to put down her book. "Sister Liang, can we have both?"

"You're so greedy," Ling Dang paused her cartoon and said disdainfully.

"Don't you want both too?" Rainbow asked back.

Ling Dang was silent for two seconds, then looked at Liang Shi with a sweet smile. "Auntie, I want to eat first and then play."

Rainbow: "..."

She sighed helplessly.

Liang Shi looked at Ling Dang, who was leaning her head over, touched her head, and readily agreed: "Alright."

Then she asked for Rainbow's opinion. Rainbow said indifferently, "Either is fine."

Ling Dang scoffed.

The two children seemed to not get along well.

Last time Liang Shi heard Ling Dang mention something about how the little friend Ling Dang liked also liked Rainbow, so Ling Dang was hostile toward Rainbow.

However, Rainbow was still immersed in her own science fiction world, acting like a little adult, completely unable to understand Ling Dang's inexplicable hostility.

But when it came time to eat, Liang Shi still quietly educated Ling Dang: "Rainbow is Auntie's friend's child, you can't bully her, okay?"

"I didn't," Ling Dang said proudly. "I didn't even use my hands."

Liang Shi: "..."

She made a fist and waved it in front of Ling Dang. "If you dare use your hands, I'll beat you up, okay?"

Ling Dang pouted. "Auntie, you're being partial."

Liang Shi: "I'm teaching you not to target other children."

"But Shen Yiran won't play with me anymore because of her," Ling Dang said, tears welling up in her eyes. "She even said she wants to transfer to Zhou Caihong's class, wuu wuu wuu."

Liang Shi: "...?"

"Even if she says she wants to transfer, her mom might not actually transfer her," Liang Shi comforted. "And you don't only have Shen Yiran as a good friend. You can be good friends with Rainbow too."

"I don't want to!" Ling Dang said huffily. "She actually said 'Bunny Don't Cry' is a childish cartoon."

Liang Shi: "..."

Never having dealt with such childish conflicts before, Liang Shi felt quite a headache. She pressed her temples and immediately changed the subject, glossing over this matter.

She chose to let things take their natural course.

She took the two children to eat fast food again.

Originally, she had planned to have Cantonese cuisine, but Ling Dang said she didn't like drinking soup, and Rainbow suggested wanting hamburgers.

Faced with two children's pitiful pleading eyes, Liang Shi had no judgment whatsoever.

She drove to McDonald's in a daze.

There weren't many people in the restaurant now, and it was quite quiet.

The entire floor had only two tables of people chatting casually, and one table with someone seriously working on a laptop. It was quite leisurely.

Rainbow also politely put away her book and instead asked Liang Shi: "Sister Liang, what did you want to talk to Teacher Qi about?"

"Just to say hello," Liang Shi replied. "We knew each other before."

Rainbow frowned, looking quite troubled.

"What's wrong?" Liang Shi asked. "What do you want to say?"

Rainbow thought for a moment, then gestured for Liang Shi to lean her ear closer.

"This Monday and Tuesday, Teacher Qi took sick leave and didn't come to work," Rainbow lowered her voice. "On Wednesday we had PE class, and I saw Teacher Qi's knees... they were purple."

"Also, she had really serious marks on her back. I accidentally patted her back before, and then..."

At this point, Rainbow felt very guilty and said dejectedly, "Is Teacher Qi being bullied by bad people?"

Liang Shi frowned, not knowing how to discuss this with a child, so she could only deflect: "That's not clear yet. I'll ask Teacher Qi about it later."

Rainbow nodded.

Liang Shi asked again: "Has Teacher Qi had these kinds of injuries on her body before?"

Rainbow thought carefully. "In April this year, she took half a month off. When she came back, she was limping. I heard the teachers say she seemed to have sprained her ankle while hiking. But that time I also saw her applying medicine to her knees, similar to the wounds she has now."

Because Rainbow was smart, and Zhou Li often couldn't pick her up on time, she spent more time with the teachers than ordinary children and understood more about the situation.

Liang Shi asked Rainbow a few more questions, but since she was still a child after all, she didn't know much more.

But just from this information, it sounded frightening enough.

This meant Qi Jiao had been enduring Mrs. Qi's domestic violence all along.

It had truly reached a level that warranted criminal charges.

After listening, Liang Shi felt heavy-hearted. She took out her phone wanting to text Qi Jiao, but didn't know what to say.

Mrs. Qi's threatening words from last time still echoed in her ears.

Sending this text might not matter to her, but Qi Jiao would still face Mrs. Qi's threats.

So Liang Shi gave up.

She texted Xu Qingzhu asking what she wanted for dinner, and also mentioned that she would be bringing a child home that evening.

¹ A fictional children's story/cartoon mentioned in the novel